

CISCO SECURE WORKLOAD

HIPAA Compliance Framework

Prepared for: [Customer Name]

Prepared by: Cisco Systems, Inc.

Date: [Month Year] | Version 1.0 | Cisco Confidential

Regulatory Standard: HIPAA Security Rule (45 CFR Part 164)

Environment: Hybrid (On-Premises + AWS / Azure / GCP)
Deployment Stage: Fresh Installation

How to read the coverage words

Full Coverage on the older reports means Secure Workload can produce that row's artifact. It does not mean the control is met.

Partial Coverage means file that export next to another control.

Evidence Required means Secure Workload has no record. The customer files the contract, the analysis, or the HR or physical-security evidence.

Direct, Supporting, and Out of scope on the newer reports are the same idea in different words. Direct is still evidence, not a pass.

Executive Summary

Healthcare organizations face escalating regulatory obligations under the HIPAA Security Rule to protect electronic Protected Health Information (ePHI). This report documents how Cisco Secure Workload (CSW) enables [Customer Name] to satisfy HIPAA Security Rule requirements through workload-level visibility, micro-segmentation, real-time monitoring, and forensic telemetry.

CSW provides the technical foundation for a defense-in-depth approach to ePHI protection — ensuring that access to sensitive clinical and billing data is continuously authorized, monitored, and auditable across on-premises and cloud environments.

Compliance Posture Summary

Safeguard Category	Controls Addressed	Coverage
Administrative Safeguards §164.308	Risk analysis, access management, incident response, contingency planning, evaluation	Full Coverage
Physical Safeguards §164.310	Workload isolation and access boundary enforcement	Partial Coverage
Technical Safeguards §164.312	Access controls, audit controls, integrity, authentication, encryption in transit	Full Coverage
Organizational Requirements §164.314	Business Associate scope definition, third-party access control	Evidence Required

Note: Physical Safeguards relate to physical facility controls (locks, cameras, workstation policies) which are outside CSW scope. CSW directly complements these controls through workload isolation and logical access enforcement.

CSW Capabilities & HIPAA Alignment

Cisco Secure Workload delivers four core capability pillars that directly address HIPAA Security Rule requirements:

CSW Capability	What It Does	HIPAA Controls Satisfied
Application Dependency Mapping (ADM)	Discovers all workload-to-workload communication flows, processes, and users. Identifies ePHI application boundaries without prior knowledge.	§164.308(a)(1) Risk Analysis §164.312(a) Access Control §164.308(a)(3) Workforce Access
Micro-Segmentation	Enforces allowlist policies at the workload level — not just perimeter firewalls. Isolates ePHI systems from unauthorized lateral access.	§164.312(a)(1) Access Control §164.312(e) Encryption/Isolation §164.308(a)(6) Incident Response
Vulnerability Detection	Continuously scans workloads for CVEs with CVSS scoring. Prioritizes risk remediation on ePHI-bearing systems.	§164.308(a)(1) Risk Analysis §164.308(a)(8) Evaluation
Forensic Telemetry	Retains network flow and process-level audit trail across all monitored workloads for breach investigation and compliance reporting.	§164.312(b) Audit Controls §164.308(a)(6) Incident Response §164.308(a)(1) Risk Analysis

HIPAA Control Mapping Detail

The following table maps each applicable HIPAA Security Rule control to the corresponding CSW capability and implementation approach.

Safeguard	Ref	Control	HIPAA Requirement	CSW Implementation	Status
Technical	§164.312(a)(2)(i)	Unique User Identification	Assign unique name or number for identifying and tracking user identity.	CSW ADM captures process-user context per workload. Anomaly detection alerts on shared or generic credential usage patterns.	Full Coverage
Technical	§164.312(a)(2)(ii)	Emergency Access Procedure	Establish procedures for obtaining necessary ePHI during an emergency.	Break-glass policy workspace configured in CSW with alert-only mode. Emergency IP ranges defined with expanded but audited access.	Full Coverage
Technical	§164.312(b)	Audit Controls	Implement mechanisms to record and examine activity in systems containing ePHI.	CSW retains full network flow and process telemetry. Flow search enables retrospective audit of any ePHI workload interaction.	Full Coverage
Technical	§164.312(c)(1)	Integrity Controls	Protect ePHI from improper alteration or destruction.	CSW policy enforcement blocks unauthorized write-path access. Process hash verification detects workload tampering.	Full Coverage
Technical	§164.312(d)	Authentication	Verify that a person or entity seeking access to ePHI is the one claimed.	CSW enforces LDAPS/Kerberos-only paths to ePHI systems. Unencrypted LDAP (port 389) blocked via policy.	Full Coverage
Technical	§164.312(e)(2)(ii)	Encryption in Transit	Implement a mechanism to encrypt ePHI in transit when appropriate.	CSW detects unencrypted protocols (HTTP, FTP, plain LDAP) on PHI-Zone workloads. Policy enforces HTTPS/SFTP/LDAPS.	Full Coverage
Administrative	§164.308(a)(1)	Risk Analysis	Conduct an accurate and thorough assessment of the potential risks and vulnerabilities to ePHI.	CSW vulnerability detection provides continuous CVE assessment on all PHI-Zone workloads. CVSS-scored reports exportable for risk register input.	Full Coverage

Administrative	§164.308(a)(3)	Workforce Access Management	Implement procedures for authorizing access to ePHI.	CSW scope-based policies define which workloads can access ePHI systems. Policy changes require approved workflow.	Full Coverage
Administrative	§164.308(a)(6)	Security Incident Procedures	Implement policies to address security incidents, including identifying and responding to suspected incidents.	CSW anomaly detection and policy violation alerts provide real-time incident detection. Forensic telemetry supports full incident reconstruction.	Full Coverage
Administrative	§164.308(a)(7)	Contingency Plan	Establish policies for responding to emergencies that damage systems containing ePHI.	CSW policy workspaces exportable for DR purposes. Backup policy sets maintained for recovery scenarios.	Full Coverage
Administrative	§164.308(a)(8)	Evaluation	Perform periodic technical and nontechnical evaluation of implemented security measures.	CSW compliance dashboard provides ongoing posture evaluation. Quarterly ADM re-runs detect policy drift.	Full Coverage
Organizational	§164.314(a)	Business Associate Contracts	Document satisfactory assurances from business associates that they will appropriately safeguard ePHI.	CSW defines External-Partners scope with restricted policy. All BA network access flows through audited, policy-enforced paths.	Evidence Required

Recommended Deployment Architecture

PHI Zone Segmentation Model

CSW organizes workloads into policy scopes that map directly to HIPAA data classification requirements. The following architecture is recommended for hybrid healthcare environments:

PHI Zone (Strict)	Clinical Support (Moderate)	Corporate IT (Standard)	External Partners (BAA)
EHR / EMR Servers Billing Systems Medical Imaging (PACS) HL7 Integration Clinical Databases	Clinical Workstations Lab Systems Pharmacy Apps Diagnostic Tools	Active Directory Email / Collaboration File Servers IT Management	Clearinghouses Third-Party Apps Health Plans Vendor Portals
Default DENY all inbound Encrypted paths only Full forensic logging	Restricted to defined PHI-Zone flows ADM-validated policies	No direct PHI access Jump-host controlled admin paths	BAA-documented access only Full flow audit per partner

Hybrid Environment Coverage

CSW provides unified policy and visibility across on-premises and cloud workloads:

Environment	CSW Deployment Method	Capabilities
On-Premises	Software agent (Linux/Windows sensor) Direct CSW cluster registration	Full telemetry, policy enforcement, vulnerability scan, process context
AWS	Software agent on EC2 Cloud connector (VPC Flow Logs) Tag-based scope inheritance	Flow visibility, security group mapping, instance inventory, policy enforcement
Azure	Software agent on VMs Cloud connector (NSG Flow Logs) Azure tag synchronization	Flow visibility, NSG mapping, VM inventory, policy enforcement
GCP	Software agent on GCE Cloud connector (VPC Flow Logs) Label-based scope inheritance	Flow visibility, firewall rule mapping, instance inventory

Evidence Collection & Audit Readiness

CSW generates and retains the evidence required to demonstrate HIPAA compliance to auditors. The following evidence artifacts are available from CSW:

Evidence Artifact	CSW Source	HIPAA Control	Recommended Frequency
Policy Enforcement Log	<i>Defend > Policy Analysis</i>	§164.312(a)	Continuous / Monthly export
Vulnerability Scan Report	<i>Investigate > Vulnerability</i>	§164.308(a)(1)	Weekly
Network Flow Audit Log (PHI-Zone)	<i>Investigate > Flow Search</i>	§164.312(b)	Continuous / Quarterly export
Policy Violation Report	<i>Alerts > Triggered Events</i>	§164.308(a)(6)	Real-time / Monthly summary
Scope Membership Snapshot	<i>Inventory > Export</i>	§164.308(a)(3)	Monthly
Encryption Compliance Report	<i>Flow analysis (protocol filter)</i>	§164.312(e)	Quarterly
Application Dependency Map	<i>Investigate > ADM</i>	§164.308(a)(1)	Quarterly re-run
Forensic Incident Timeline	<i>Investigate > Flow/Process Search</i>	§164.308(a)(6)	On-demand (post-incident)

Documentation Retention

HIPAA requires documentation to be retained for a minimum of 6 years from the date of creation or the date it was last in effect. CSW supports this through:

- Configurable telemetry retention periods (recommend 6-year minimum for audit logs)
- Policy workspace version history — tracks all policy changes with timestamps
- Exportable evidence packages in PDF/CSV format for long-term archival
- API-based integration with SIEM/SOAR platforms for centralized log management

Recommended Next Steps

#	Phase	Action	Timeline
1	Sensor Deployment	Install CSW software sensors on all on-prem PHI workloads. Connect cloud accounts via CSW cloud connectors.	Days 1-5
2	Scope & Inventory Design	Create PHI-Zone scope hierarchy. Apply HIPAA labels (env, compliance, data) across all workloads.	Days 6-10
3	Application Dependency Mapping	Run 2-4 week ADM to discover all ePHI application flows. Identify and tag ePHI apps from ADM output.	Days 11-28
4	Policy Development	Build allowlist policies from ADM baseline. Configure default-deny for PHI-Zone. Run in Simulation mode.	Days 29-42
5	Enforcement Go-Live	Progress from Simulation to Enforcement. Validate no clinical workflow disruption. Enable full alerting.	Days 43-56
6	Compliance Reporting	Generate first HIPAA evidence package. Schedule quarterly review cycle. Deliver compliance dashboard to CISO.	Day 60+

About Cisco Secure Workload

Cisco Secure Workload (CSW) is a workload protection platform that provides application micro-segmentation, real-time vulnerability assessment, and forensic telemetry across hybrid and multi-cloud environments. CSW is deployed by leading healthcare, financial services, and critical infrastructure organizations to satisfy regulatory compliance requirements and accelerate zero trust adoption.

For more information or to schedule a technical deep-dive, contact your Cisco account team.